Lerlene Escapes the Bubbas from Alter Egos

By John McGovern

INTRODUCTION

You know you're "trailer trash" when . . . 1) The Halloween pumpkin on your porch has more teeth than your boyfriend. 2) You wonder how service stations keep their restroom so clean. 3) You have to go outside to get something from the fridge or 4) Your name is Lerlene and you just escaped from the Bubbas.

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LERLENE: Ohmigod! I just had this – *epiphany* – I think that's the word – it was like a flash of just knowin' – I had to get out! So, I just ran out of my trailer fast as I could – I only took my Merry-Go-Round handbag and my two little dogs. I had to get out! The Bubbas were drivin' me crazy! When I say the Bubbas I mean my boyfriend Bubba and his two kids. *(Pause as the emotion builds inside of her.)*

Bubba *(On the pouty verge of tears)* and Bubba – the man named his two sons the same thing – which woulda been fine if they hadn't been twins! Oh those kids! Always wantin' somethin' – attention . . . Food! Water! I can't be bothered with that – especially not durin' my soap-opera slash talk-show hours! First of all . . .

(Her voice moves into her seductive range) I'm gonna be an actress. So soap operas are like crucial actin' lessons for me . . .

(A sudden switch back to the loud Lerlene we've met before) . . . and second, I need to see the talk shows 'cause sometimes that's the only way I get to see my family! I mean, last week I missed my cousins BaSita and FaNita on Jerry Springer! Anyway, the main reason I left is . . . 'cause . . . well . . .

(Does a Wonder Woman-style twirl) I'm gon' be famous! . . . a supermodel/ singer/actress – triple threat! And I need to be in a situation with a man who is going to support me in my career! 'Cause I'm on my way . . . I'm in training, I practice like, um, runway walkin' here in the trailer park . . . it's like . . . watch . . .

(Runs upstage and strikes her starting pose, then begins to walk) One-two-work it one-two and look and look and look and look. . . I do Vogue covers, it's like . . . chick chick *(She poses)*

Chick chick *(Another awful pose halfway between a cheerleading pose and a porno still.)*

I'm ready . . . ready to be . . . discovered. *(She throws one hand in the air in a glamourous pose, but then breaks down.)*

But Bubba, Bubba and Bubba didn't want to let me go! Old Bubba just wanted us to get married and for me to get fat and pregnant! Now first of all, if I'm gonna be a supermodel I can't be fat, I gotta make sure to stay thin. I sometimes eat nuthin' but Slim Fast for days – fried Slim Fast, Slim Fast fricassee, baked Slim Fast, Slim Fast ice cream, Slim Fast muffins – you know,

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'cause I know that Naomi Campbell don't have no cellulite so I better not neither! *(Slaps her butt)*

I work out too! I don't have 'nuff money to join no gym so I do my workout anywhere I can. I love doing that Stairmaster but I can't get on them big-ass machines, so I just do the low-cost Stairmaster. I go to a really tall building and I just run up and down the stairs . . . *(Starts feigning her workout)* . . . till I've burned at least a thousand calories and then I just drop! *(Falls dramatically to the ground.)*

Then I just hope that some cute businessman or security guard will call me an ambulance, 'cause then I get a free ride home! I've done other stuff too – I've made one o' them, um, ab-isolators, you know? Outta a wire hanger and two tin cans. I been ingenious 'bout it! I should be one of those girls on TV. I should be one o' them Spice Girls! We need some American Spice! I could be . . . Southern Spice! Or Kentucky Fried Spice! I could do that! I should be selling stuff on TV. That's what I should be doing! I could be one o' them girls on those infomercials! Like, um . . .

(Runs to one side of the stage and mimes a very sexual selling technique rubbing the appliance) Buy this . . . .

(Runs to the other side and repeats it in an even "hussier" manner) Buy THIS! But . . . I gotta get me a better wardrobe! I been stealin' all I can --- hence my Merry-Go-Round handbag. But I can't do it no more – 'cause I got myself caught last time I was at . . . Contempo Casuals . . . and they had this 89.95 leather skirt and I tried to like crush it up in my purse, just, you know, squish

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it down in there . . . *(Pause)* . . . they weren't amused . . . the cops came and got me – the fuzz . . . and they just threw me up against the wall and frisked me, I felt just like Miss Alyssa Milano in a bad movie of the week . . . I just wouldn't know what to do if I got caught again . . . Now . . . what I need is for a good man ta buy me thangs 'n' make me famous . . .

(To someone in the audience) Go ahead – call me a gold digger, I don't care!! Hell, gold is in this season! *(She sashays to the other side of the stage and cozies up to a different audience member)* Actually, right now I'm just a digger . . . *(Back to the other person)* . . . but when I hit the gold I know you'll be jealous, girl! Right now I'm livin' off the tiny paychecks I get from the lottery – no I didn't win nuthin', I wish – I'm the girl who picks up the numbers and says 'em to the camera. *(Miming what she does on the show in a sexually charged, slow and sensual manner.)*

Like "One . . . Fifteen" . . . See, it's a good job because it really fulfills part of my triple-threat training: supermodel – 'cause I'm modeling the numbers, actress – 'cause I gotta act like I care who wins if it ain't me and singer – 'cause, well, I hum tunes to maself when I get bored on the set. But I need somethin' better than that! So that's why I left. I mean Bubba means well, he makes a great tuna salad sandwich and he can play Janet Jackson songs doin' that underarm fart thing. But I need a more upwardly mobile-supportive environment. I can't settle! And I'm not gonna take care o' no kids till I'm ready! So that's why after my epiphany! I just know it's time to get outta here. So I'm goin' down to the Motel 6 and I'm gon' stay there until I can get enough money to go to Hollywood. And I'm changin' my name too . . . To Lerlene Famoos. . . see, you pronounce it Famoos but you spell it F-a-m-o-u-s so when

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you write it you see Lerlene FAMOUS! You know what else I did? I got me the same motivational book as Demi Moore says she had! She said it was the key to her success. I mean . . . I didn't read it yet, but . . . I put it in the corner of my trailer and the vibes it gives off make me feel stronger! I know if I focus, am really nice to people and get the right pair of shoes – I'm gonna make it. I just gotta be famous!

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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